

file despite being the MD & CEO of a liquor giant, talks in terms of months, not years.

PUTTING IT TOGETHER

Sitting in her austere office, the MD & CEO pauses briefly to adjust her green blazer before recalling one of the early strategy meetings right after she took over in July 2021. Nagarajan's table is clean, and her room is sparse (We are drinking tea, and there is no display of Diageo's 63 alcohol brands in the room). Most importantly, she is relaxed, which is admirable given the complex regulations, tax rates and even bottle sizes across states. Some states depend heavily on taxes from liquor revenues.

"The first thing we asked ourselves was what we stood for. It was clear that we had to set ourselves a mission to be among India's top-performing consumer



VIKRAM DAMODARAN
CHIEF INNOVATION
OFFICER,
DIAGEO INDIA

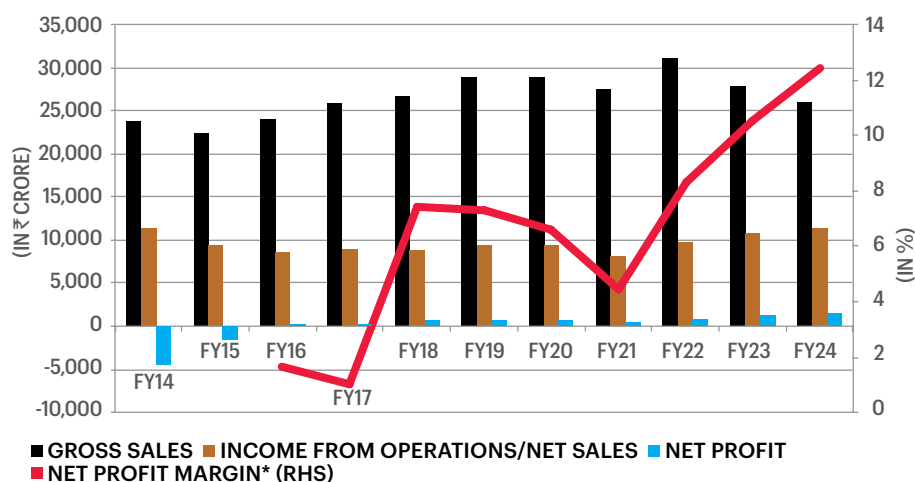
"They may think it is retro, but it is also progressive, and for the youngsters, it is a new brand. McDowell's has very high equity, and it makes perfect sense to build on it"

BIG SHOT

► From a loss-making entity, the company has double-digit profit margins ► Analysts say the future looks optimistic, with a changing demographic

NOTE *CALCULATED AS NET PROFIT/NET SALES; USL WAS ACQUIRED IN FY14, SO NET PROFIT MARGIN IS AVAILABLE FROM FY16

SOURCE ACE EQUITY, ANNUAL REPORTS



RAISING A TOAST

► The United Spirits stock has seen a sharp spike in the past three years ► A better run operation augurs well for the medium- to long-term, say company watchers

NOTE DATA HAS BEEN INDEXED TO 100 **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY

*DIAGEO INDIA IS INCORPORATED AS UNITED SPIRITS LTD (USL)

